COMMON CENTS · FINANCIAL FORECAST

Priya's next 12 months

Second-year student on a maintenance loan

Prepared 07 November 2026
Based on 18 months of transactions
1,000 simulated futures

There's a 100% chance you go below £0 before your next payment (Student Finance England, 12 Jan).

Answer to your biggest worry: Running out of money before payday

BALANCE TODAY	IN 30 DAYS	IN 90 DAYS	HARDSHIP RISK
£420	**–£175**	**£89**	**12%** LOW
Overdraft limit £1,500 · savings £150	likely –£330 to –£51 · High confidence (91%)	likely –£238 to £364 · High confidence (84%)	High confidence · £200 more savings → 9%

Your balance: last 3 months and next 12 months



Actual balance · Most likely forecast · Likely range (8 in 10 futures fall here) · Forecast without your life changes · Overdraft limit

How to read this: the dark line is what actually happened. The blue line is the most likely path from today; the shaded band shows where your balance lands in 8 out of 10 simulated futures. The wider the band, the less certain the forecast. Below £0 is expected around **01 December 2026**.

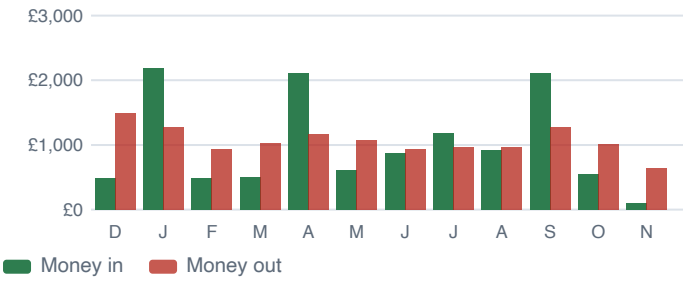
What's driving your risk

- Savings would cover 0.6 months of spending
- Savings haven't grown in 6 months
- You'd cover a £500 surprise bill with your overdraft

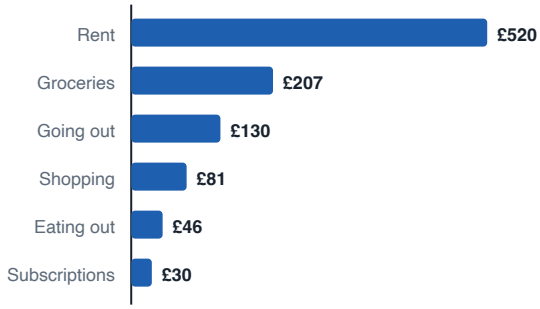
Planned life changes

- **Graduation** from 01 Jul 2027: £1,700 of student loan payments stop.
  Assumption: Student loan payments stop after graduation in July.

Income vs spending, last 12 months



Where your money goes (per month)



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What could happen, and what you can do

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Your alerts

RISK · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Rent will likely take you overdrawn

Your £520 rent to Unite Students on 1 December is likely to take your balance to about -£134. It's forecast to reach around -£977 by 11 January, the day before your next Student Finance payment of £1,650.

Why am I seeing this? Based on your bill calendar, the 1 December rent payment and the forecast for the day before your 12 January loan payment.

Try: Plan ahead for December by setting aside part of each weekly SU Bar wage of £102 before rent day.

FORECAST · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Your safe-to-spend until 12 January

To stay within your £1,500 overdraft, keep everyday spending under £21 a day until your loan arrives. You usually spend about £16 a day, so this is within reach.

Why am I seeing this? Your safe-to-spend figure covers the 65 days to 12 January, alongside last year's December spending, which was about £484 higher than a typical month.

Try: Try a 48-hour wait before any non-essential buy over £30, especially around Christmas.

RESILIENCE · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Two changes that shorten your time overdrawn

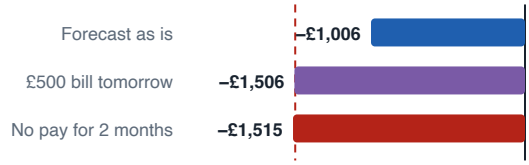
Spending half as much on going out (about £65 a month) could cut your expected days overdrawn from about 61 to 50. Halving shopping as well (about £40 a month) brings it to about 43 days and lifts your lowest expected balance from -£1,006 to -£794.

Why am I seeing this? Our action plan tested these changes over the next 120 days. It also notes that in the 3 days after money comes in, you spend about 8.3 times your usual on non-essentials.

Try: On 12 January, move your fun money into a separate pot, so your main account only covers bills.

Written by Claude from the forecast data above.

Stress tests: lowest expected balance



SCENARIO (NEXT 90 DAYS)	BELOW £0	PAST OVERDRAFT
Forecast as is	100%	1%
£500 bill tomorrow	100%	53%
No pay for 2 months	100%	63%

YOUR GOAL: BUILD SAVINGS

Saving £25 a month gets you to £3,120 in 119 months.

Target: 3 months of spending as an emergency fund

Your answers: Build savings · Running out of money before payday · Graduation · £500 bill: Overdraft

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Coming up, and ways to get ahead

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Coming up: bills and spending spikes we expect

WHEN	WHAT	EXPECTED COST	CONFIDENCE	WHY WE THINK SO
December 2026	**Seasonal spending increase**	£387–£580	High	Your December spending was about £484 higher than a typical month last year
January 2027	**Seasonal spending increase**	£178–£267	High	Your January spending was about £223 higher than a typical month last year
31 Dec – 28 Jan 2027	**Travel pass** 16-25 Railcard	£29–£35	Medium	You paid 16-25 Railcard £30 around this time last year
April 2027	**Seasonal spending increase**	£116–£173	High	Your April spending was about £144 higher than a typical month last year
11 Sep – 09 Oct 2027	**Education costs** Blackwell's Books	£81–£99	High	You paid Blackwell's Books £85 around this time last year

Opportunities

OPPORTUNITY	BENEFIT	SUGGESTED ACTION	CONFIDENCE
Spread your loan instalment Your income arrives in large lumps a few times a year	–	Move each loan payment to savings and pay yourself a weekly allowance	Medium

How this forecast was made. We found your regular income and bills from payment patterns, then simulated 1,000 possible futures, drawing day-to-day spending from your own history with seasonal effects (for example Christmas) and inflation. Risk scores combine the forecast with trends in your overdraft use, savings, income and bills; every factor is listed above. Economic figures and life-event costs are estimates and are listed in the data.

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Your plan

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Smallest changes with the biggest effect

1. **Spend 50% less on going out (about £65 a month)**
   (harder · lowest balance then –£875)
2. **Spend 50% less on shopping (about £40 a month)**
   (harder · lowest balance then –£794)
3. **Spend 50% less on eating out (about £23 a month)**
   (harder · lowest balance then –£748)

NEXT 120 DAYS	NOW	WITH THE PLAN
Lowest expected balance	–£1,006	**–£748**
Days overdrawn (expected)	61	**40**
Chance of going past overdraft	1%	**0%**

Greedy search over 1,000 simulated futures: each round adds the change with the biggest risk reduction per unit of effort.

SAFE TO SPEND

£21 a day

Staying above £0 until 12 Jan isn't likely. To stay within your £1,500 overdraft, keep everyday spending under £21 a day (you usually spend £16).

Next few days of bills and income

DATE	WHO	AMOUNT	BALANCE AFTER
Fri 13 Nov	SU Bar Payroll	+£102	£482
Sun 15 Nov	Spotify	–£7	£429
Fri 20 Nov	SU Bar Payroll	+£102	£469
Fri 20 Nov	Three Mobile	–£15	£469
Fri 27 Nov	SU Bar Payroll	+£102	£475
Tue 01 Dec	Unite Students	–£520	–£134

Spending patterns we noticed

- In the 3 days after money comes in, you spend about 8.3× your usual on non-essentials.
- 6 days in the last 6 months had unusually high non-essential spending (£480 in total).

For your stage of life (student)

- Check when your interest-free student overdraft ends after graduation, and plan to clear it before then.
- Treat each loan payment as money for the whole term: divide it by the weeks until the next one.

Support you asked for

I struggle with impulse spending (you asked)

We show your safe-to-spend amount and flag spending bursts after payday.

- Try a 48-hour wait before non-essential buys over £30
- Move fun money into a separate pot on payday, so the main account only covers bills
- Remove saved cards from shopping apps

Support preferences only change how information is shown. They are never used in any score or shared.

HOW ACCURATE IS THIS FORECAST?

Tested on 3 past periods: average error £290 vs £446 for the best simple guess (35% better). The 80% range contained the real balance 56% of the time.

Risk model: gradient-boosted trees trained on 1,744 simulated customers. On 582 customers it never saw, it ranked risk correctly 95% of the time (ROC-AUC 0.949), compared with 88% for a hand-written formula.

We re-ran the model as if it were 60, 90, 120 days ago and compared it with what really happened. Measured on the demo data, which is synthetic.